



NEIGHBORHOOD WATCH is *us*!

It is neighbors watching out for neighbors, working with our PVE Police Department to notify them of suspicious activities in our neighborhoods. Part of the beauty of our community is the safety and friendliness of our neighborhoods. There are many ways we can work together to keep our special community safe:

- * Get to know your neighbors—take time to knock on doors and introduce yourself.
- * Employ safe practices—be safe, be aware, be prepared. If you see something—say something.
- * Be aware of scams—and make your neighbors aware of things to watch out for.
- * Protect your homes from opportunities for crime—be alert and be vigilant.
- * Notify our **Police Department** of suspicious activity at the non-emergency #: **310-378-4211**

How we define being successful as a Block Captain involves **three (3) simple tasks**. But first, let's define the Block Captain role.

As a Block Captain, we do things to **help create community**.

- a. We are communication coordinators who help communicate with other neighbors on our street. Help be a conduit between Neighborhood Watch (especially the Board and Area Coordinators), the PVE Police and the neighbors.
- b. We are facilitators who facilitate neighbors' involvement.
- c. We keep in mind that we are no more important than any of the other neighbors and we have no greater authority over them—we are simply here to serve our neighbors and our community.

3 Block Captain Tasks:

1. Gather NAMES and CONTACT INFO (phone and email) for every home on your Street (approximately 10-12 homes), so that the Block Captain can contact them in case of an Emergency. This is a proprietary list and should not be share with anyone else or used in any other way other than to help in case of emergency. If **all** the people on the block sign-off and say it's OK to share that info with the people on your block, then you can do that so you can help neighbors help neighbors.
2. Invite everyone on your "Block" to meet at least once a year, either on the street or in a home, and include PVENW and the Police to talk with them about Safety for that particular Block. You can easily plan to meet on the street, and after pandemic restrictions are lifted, you can meet in someone's home.
3. Ask neighbors to actively SEE SOMETHING—SAY SOMETHING whenever something looks odd on the street or in our neighborhood. Let our residents know that it is important to contact our PVE Police Department on the non-Emergency number: 310-378-4211 if and when they see something that is out of the ordinary.

What can we do beyond simply being neighbors? September 28 is **NATIONAL GOOD NEIGHBOR DAY**. We invite all Block Captains to use this opportunity to reach out to neighbors at least in September, but any time of the year that may make sense for your Block.

One of the main goals of Neighborhood Watch is to have a safe and connected community.

Neighborhood Watch is a crime prevention program enlisting the active participation of residents in cooperation with the Police Department to reduce the incidence and fear of crime in their communities. It involves neighbors getting to know each other to develop a program of mutual assistance. It involves neighbors being educated in crime reporting and suspect identification techniques. Finally, it involves neighbors using crime prevention strategies as tools to reduce crime in their communities.

PVE Neighborhood Watch is a non-profit (501c3) organization founded in 1983 and partners with our PVE Police Department.

Why Neighborhood Watch?

The community has the primary responsibility for fighting crime. The most effective approach to fighting crime is a proactive one, i.e., stopping it before it occurs. This can happen when neighbors cooperate with each other to assist the Police Department. Neighborhood Watch members place stickers in their windows and post Neighborhood Watch signs on streets, warning criminals they are in an active Neighborhood Watch community, and that “neighbors are watching out for each other.”

Remember, you and your neighbors are the ones who really know what is going on in your community. Resident involvement is essential to combat crime.

We encourage neighbors to watch out for neighbors by noticing things that are out of the ordinary:

- Strangers and solicitors.
- Someone you don't recognize who is carrying property.
- Someone going door-to-door in your neighborhood.
- Traffic to and from a certain residence.
- Any vehicle moving slowly and without lights, or following a course that appears aimless or repetitive in any location.
- Parked vehicles containing one or more persons.
- Any abandoned vehicles parked on your block.
- Continuous repair operations at non-business locations.
- Persons making a quick change of vehicles.
- One or more individuals, including juveniles walking through the neighborhood looking into automobiles or backyards.
- Any person taking a shortcut through a backyard.
- Watch out for neighbors who leave laptops or keys in cars.
- Encourage neighbors to lock cars and homes.